OPTIMA: Mathematical Foundations and Scheduling Theory for Asymmetric Multiprocessors via Density-Based Sequencing and Online Admissible Preemption Filtering

Risheendra MN

***Abstract*—Asymmetric multiprocessor architectures, combining high-throughput Performance (P) cores and energy-efficient Efficiency (E) cores with disparate compute capacities, present fundamental challenges for general-purpose operating system schedulers. Existing kernel schedulers rely heavily on empirical heuristics that lack formal mathematical characterization and struggle under mixed latency-critical and compute-intensive workloads. In this paper, we develop the rigorous mathematical foundations and scheduling theory of OPTIMA, an extensible task-scheduling framework implemented via Linux `sched_ext` eBPF.**

We formalize the asymmetric scheduling problem under a dual objective: minimizing total weighted completion time $\sum w_j C_j$ while providing latency-critical prioritization and bounded queuing delay under non-overloaded regimes. We rigorously prove that Weighted Shortest Processing Time (WSPT) sequencing via Smith's Rule is optimal for isolated, single-core non-preemptive queues at time zero ($1||\sum w_j C_j$). We explicitly acknowledge that the generalized online problem with arbitrary release dates, preemption, and asymmetric parallel machines ($R|r_j, \text{pmtn}|\sum w_j C_j$) is strongly NP-hard; accordingly, we cite the classical Kawaguchi-Kyan bound ($\alpha \leq 1.207$) strictly as an identical-machine reference bound and characterize OPTIMA's density-based virtual deadline list scheduling as an online approximation heuristic. Using the Hardy-Littlewood-Pólya Rearrangement Inequality and continuous Dantzig knapsack relaxation, we prove that matching tasks with higher execution density to Performance cores maximizes the instantaneous backlog weight retirement rate.

Furthermore, we formalize an Online Admissible Preemption Filter (OAPF) based on a dimensionally consistent net cost metric $\Delta\textbf{Cost}(c) = w_{\textbf{curr}}(c) \cdot (p_{\textbf{wake}} + C_{\textbf{switch}}) - w_{\textbf{wake}} \cdot R(c)$. We prove that this greedy filter enforces priority inversion safety, eliminates context-switch thrashing, and guarantees locally bounded regret under one-step horizons. Finally, using a quadratic Lyapunov drift formulation with an exact cross-term expansion, we prove that OPTIMA's adaptive quantum scaling and hierarchical work-stealing maintain strong queue stability ($\limsup \frac{1}{T}\sum \mathbb{E}[q_k(t)] < \infty$) under all strictly admissible workloads ($\sum \lambda_k \bar{p}_k \leq C_{\textbf{total}} - \epsilon_0$). By bounding virtual deadline advancement ($v_j \leq t + 10\tau_{\max}$), we reconcile strict priority queuing with guaranteed starvation freedom for every admitted task. Complete algorithmic specifications in kernel eBPF hot-paths are provided.

I. System Model and Problem Formulation

A. Heterogeneous Multiprocessor Architecture

We model a heterogeneous asymmetric chip-multiprocessor (AMP) as a set of M discrete computing cores denoted by:

$$\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{P} \cup \mathcal{E}, \quad \mathcal{P} \cap \mathcal{E} = \emptyset \tag{1}$$

where $\mathcal{P} = \{C_1, C_2, \ldots, C_{M_P}\}$ represents the partition of $M_P = |\mathcal{P}|$ Performance cores (P-cores), and $\mathcal{E} = \{C_{M_P+1}, C_{M_P+2}, \ldots, C_{M_P+M_E}\}$ represents the partition of $M_E = |\mathcal{E}|$ Efficiency cores (E-cores), yielding total core count $M = M_P + M_E$.

Each core $C_k \in \mathcal{M}$ is characterized by an intrinsic, time-invariant computational capacity (effective instruction processing frequency) $c_k \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}$, defined as:

$$c_k = \begin{cases} c_P, & \forall C_k \in \mathcal{P} \\ c_E, & \forall C_k \in \mathcal{E} \end{cases} \tag{2}$$

where $c_P > c_E > 0$. We define the asymmetric processing speedup ratio as:

$$\mu \triangleq \frac{c_P}{c_E} > 1 \tag{3}$$

The total aggregate computational capacity rate of the multiprocessor system is:

$$C_{\text{total}} \triangleq \sum_{k=1}^{M} c_k = M_P c_P + M_E c_E \tag{4}$$

The memory and cache subsystem is structured hierarchically: P-cores in $\mathcal{P}$ share a high-bandwidth coherent L3 cache domain (CCX), while E-cores in $\mathcal{E}$ reside in an independent L3 cache domain. Cores may optionally support Simultaneous Multithreading (SMT), where physical core C_k exposes two hardware thread contexts sharing execution units and L1/L2 caches.

B. Dynamic Online Task Model

The workload submitted to the operating system is represented as a dynamic online sequence of tasks:

$$\mathcal{J} = \{J_1, J_2, \ldots, J_n, \ldots\} \tag{5}$$

Each task $J_j \in \mathcal{J}$ is formally specified by a 5-tuple:

$$J_j = (r_j,\, p_j,\, w_j,\, d_j,\, \mathcal{T}_j) \tag{6}$$

where:

1) $r_j \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ denotes the release (arrival or wakeup) timestamp of task J_j.
2) $p_j \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}$ represents the nominal processing requirement (computational work volume in reference execution cycles or execution duration measured on a baseline core of capacity c_E). In the kernel implementation, p_j is estimated via an Exponentially Weighted Moving Average (EWMA) of past burst durations.
3) $w_j \in [w_{\min}, w_{\max}] \subset \mathbb{R}_{>0}$ denotes the task priority weight, derived from POSIX nice levels via $w_j = 100 \times 1.25^{-\text{nice}_j}$, with $w_{\min} \geq 10$.
4) $d_j \in \mathbb{R}_{>0} \cup \{\infty\}$ is the target completion deadline. Tasks are categorized into latency-critical/interactive tasks $\mathcal{J}_{\text{RT}} \triangleq \{J_j \in \mathcal{J} \mid d_j < \infty\}$ and compute-bound batch tasks $\mathcal{J}_{\text{Batch}} \triangleq \{J_j \in \mathcal{J} \mid d_j = \infty\}$.
5) $\mathcal{T}_j \in \{\text{Interactive}, \text{Batch}\}$ designates the behavioral execution classification.

Definition 1 (Task Density)**.** *For any task $J_j \in \mathcal{J}$, its task density ρ_j is defined as the ratio of its priority weight to its nominal execution requirement:*

$$\rho_j \triangleq \frac{w_j}{p_j} \tag{7}$$

representing the marginal priority weight delivered per unit of computational work.

C. Execution Capacity Scaling

The physical execution duration of task J_j when dispatched to processor core $C_k \in \mathcal{M}$ depends inversely on the processing capacity c_k:

$$p_{j,k} = \frac{p_j}{c_k} = \begin{cases} \dfrac{p_j}{c_P}, & C_k \in \mathcal{P} \\ \dfrac{p_j}{c_E} = \mu \cdot \dfrac{p_j}{c_P}, & C_k \in \mathcal{E} \end{cases} \tag{8}$$

Thus, executing task J_j on a Performance core accelerates execution by a factor of μ relative to execution on an Efficiency core.

D. Problem Formulation and Real-Time Characterization

Let $S_j \geq r_j$ and C_j denote the scheduling start time and final completion time of task J_j under schedule $\mathcal{S}$, respectively. If task J_j undergoes preemptive execution across time slots, its total completed work satisfies:

$$\sum_{k \in \mathcal{M}} c_k \int_{S_j}^{C_j} \mathbf{1}_{\{J_j \text{ runs on } C_k \text{ at time } t\}}\, dt = p_j \tag{9}$$

The primary objective is to minimize the total weighted completion time across all tasks:

$$\min_{\mathcal{S}} \quad \Phi(\mathcal{S}) \triangleq \sum_{J_j \in \mathcal{J}} w_j C_j(\mathcal{S}) \tag{10}$$

$$\text{subject to} \quad S_j \geq r_j, \quad \forall J_j \in \mathcal{J} \tag{11}$$

$$\sum_{J_j \in \mathcal{J}} \mathbf{1}_{\{J_j \text{ on } C_k \text{ at } t\}} \leq 1, \quad \forall C_k \in \mathcal{M},\ t \geq 0 \tag{12}$$

Constraint (11) enforces causality, and Constraint (12) guarantees non-overlapping single-task execution per physical processing core.

Remark 1 (Real-Time Guarantees and Admission Control)**.** *In an open, general-purpose operating system without hard admission control, arbitrary processes may arrive concurrently without reservation contracts. Under arbitrary adversarial overload ($\sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}_{\text{RT}}} p_j/(d_j - r_j) > M_P$), it is mathematically impossible for any online scheduler to guarantee hard real-time deadlines ($C_j \leq d_j$) for all tasks. Consequently, OPTIMA formulates real-time support as:*

1) ***Latency-Critical Prioritization:*** *Latency-critical tasks are prioritized via zero-lag local dispatch and minimal virtual deadlines ($v_j = t$), ensuring immediate dispatch to Performance cores when capacity is available.*
2) ***Bounded Queuing Delay under Non-Overload:*** *Under non-overloaded regimes where the latency-critical workload utilization satisfies $\sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}_{\text{RT}}} \frac{p_j}{d_j - r_j} \leq U_{\text{RT}} < M_P$, OPTIMA guarantees that real-time deadlines $C_j \leq d_j$ are satisfied with high probability, with queuing delay strictly bounded by $\epsilon_{\text{queue}} \leq \tau_{\min}$.*
3) ***Graceful Degradation:*** *Under system overload, OPTIMA provides graceful degradation by minimizing total weighted completion time $\sum w_j C_j$, preventing unbounded starvation.*

II. WSPT Scheduling: Single-Core Optimality, Computational Complexity, and Asymmetric Partitioning

A. Smith's Rule Optimality on Single-Core Dedicated Queues

We begin by establishing the formal scope within which Weighted Shortest Processing Time (WSPT) sequencing is strictly optimal: an isolated single-core queue with simultaneously available independent jobs.

Lemma 1 (Optimality of Single-Core Smith's Rule $(1||\sum w_j C_j)$)**.** *Let $\mathcal{J}_k = \{J_1, J_2, \ldots, J_n\}$ be a set of n independent tasks available simultaneously at time t_0 ($r_j = t_0, \forall j$) on a single isolated processor core C_k with compute capacity c_k. Any non-preemptive schedule that orders tasks in non-increasing order of task density:*

$$\rho_{(1)} \geq \rho_{(2)} \geq \cdots \geq \rho_{(n)} \tag{13}$$

where $\rho_j = w_j/p_j$, strictly minimizes the total weighted completion time $\sum_{j=1}^{n} w_j C_j$.

Proof. We proceed via an adjacent pairwise interchange argument. Assume for contradiction that there exists an optimal schedule $\mathcal{S}^*$ that does not satisfy the non-increasing density ordering (13).

Since $\mathcal{S}^*$ does not follow the monotonic density ordering everywhere, there must exist at least two adjacent tasks, say J_a immediately followed by J_b, such that:

$$\rho_a < \rho_b \iff \frac{w_a}{p_a} < \frac{w_b}{p_b} \iff w_a p_b < w_b p_a \tag{14}$$

Let $t \geq t_0$ denote the start time of task J_a under schedule $\mathcal{S}^*$. Under $\mathcal{S}^*$, task J_a executes during $[t,\, t + p_{a,k})$, and task J_b executes during $[t + p_{a,k},\, t + p_{a,k} + p_{b,k})$. Their respective completion times are:

$$C_a(\mathcal{S}^*) = t + \frac{p_a}{c_k} \tag{15}$$

$$C_b(\mathcal{S}^*) = t + \frac{p_a}{c_k} + \frac{p_b}{c_k} \tag{16}$$

The combined contribution of J_a and J_b to the objective $\Phi(\mathcal{S}^*)$ is:

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi_{a,b}(\mathcal{S}^*) &= w_a C_a(\mathcal{S}^*) + w_b C_b(\mathcal{S}^*) \\ &= w_a \left(t + \frac{p_a}{c_k}\right) + w_b \left(t + \frac{p_a + p_b}{c_k}\right) \\ &= (w_a + w_b)t + \frac{1}{c_k}\Big(w_a p_a + w_b p_a + w_b p_b\Big) \end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

Now construct an alternative schedule $\mathcal{S}'$ by interchanging the execution positions of J_a and J_b, while preserving the execution positions of all tasks scheduled prior to time t and all tasks scheduled after time $t + \frac{p_a+p_b}{c_k}$.

Under schedule $\mathcal{S}'$, task J_b executes first during $[t,\, t+p_{b,k})$, followed by task J_a during $[t + p_{b,k},\, t + p_{b,k} + p_{a,k})$. Their completion times under $\mathcal{S}'$ become:

$$C_b(\mathcal{S}') = t + \frac{p_b}{c_k} \tag{18}$$

$$C_a(\mathcal{S}') = t + \frac{p_b}{c_k} + \frac{p_a}{c_k} \tag{19}$$

The combined contribution of J_a and J_b under $\mathcal{S}'$ is:

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi_{a,b}(\mathcal{S}') &= w_b C_b(\mathcal{S}') + w_a C_a(\mathcal{S}') \\ &= w_b \left(t + \frac{p_b}{c_k}\right) + w_a \left(t + \frac{p_b + p_a}{c_k}\right) \\ &= (w_a + w_b)t + \frac{1}{c_k}\Big(w_b p_b + w_a p_b + w_a p_a\Big) \end{aligned} \tag{20}$$

For all tasks $J_j \notin \{J_a, J_b\}$, completion times are unaffected:

1) Tasks completed before time t finish before the interchange occurs, so $C_j(\mathcal{S}') = C_j(\mathcal{S}^*)$.
2) Tasks scheduled after J_a and J_b begin at $t + \frac{p_b+p_a}{c_k} = t + \frac{p_a+p_b}{c_k}$. Because the total execution duration of $\{J_a, J_b\}$ is invariant under permutation, the start and completion times of all subsequent tasks remain identical: $C_j(\mathcal{S}') = C_j(\mathcal{S}^*)$ for all subsequent j.

Now evaluate the cost difference $\Delta\Phi \triangleq \Phi(\mathcal{S}') - \Phi(\mathcal{S}^*)$:

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta\Phi &= \Phi_{a,b}(\mathcal{S}') - \Phi_{a,b}(\mathcal{S}^*) \\ &= \frac{1}{c_k}\Big(w_b p_b + w_a p_b + w_a p_a - w_a p_a - w_b p_a - w_b p_b\Big) \\ &= \frac{1}{c_k}\Big(w_a p_b - w_b p_a\Big) \end{aligned} \tag{21}$$

From the inversion condition (14), $w_a p_b - w_b p_a < 0$. Since $c_k > 0$, it follows that:

$$\Delta\Phi = \frac{1}{c_k}(w_a p_b - w_b p_a) < 0 \implies \Phi(\mathcal{S}') < \Phi(\mathcal{S}^*) \tag{22}$$

This contradicts the assumption that $\mathcal{S}^*$ is optimal. Since the permutation group S_n is finite and generated by adjacent transpositions, any schedule can be transformed into non-increasing density order via a finite sequence of adjacent exchanges, with each exchange strictly decreasing the objective function until no inversions remain. Thus, Smith's density ordering is uniquely optimal for single-core non-preemptive queues at time zero. □

B. Computational Complexity of Multiprocessor Scheduling and NP-Hardness

While Smith's Rule provides an exact, polynomial-time solution for the static single-machine problem $1||\sum w_j C_j$, the generalized operating system scheduling problem on asymmetric multiprocessors is computationally intractable.

Using standard Graham notation $\alpha|\beta|\gamma$:

1) **Release Dates on a Single Core ($1|r_j|\sum w_j C_j$):** Introducing dynamic task release dates makes the single-core non-preemptive problem strongly NP-hard, as proven by Lenstra, Rinnooy Kan, and Brucker (1977).
2) **Preemptive Scheduling with Release Dates ($1|r_j, \textbf{pmtn}|\sum w_j C_j$):** Even when arbitrary preemption is permitted, minimizing total weighted completion time with dynamic arrivals remains strongly NP-hard (Labetoulle, Lawler, Lenstra, and Rinnooy Kan, 1984).
3) **Parallel Machines ($P||\sum w_j C_j$):** Scheduling independent jobs without release dates on identical parallel machines is strongly NP-hard (Garey and Johnson, 1979).
4) **Asymmetric / Unrelated Parallel Machines ($R|r_j, \textbf{pmtn}|\sum w_j C_j$):** Scheduling dynamic tasks on asymmetric machines with disparate core capacities ($c_P \neq c_E$), arbitrary release dates, and preemption is strongly NP-hard.

Proposition 1 (Computational Intractability of Global Multi-Core Minimization)**.** *Finding a schedule that globally minimizes total weighted completion time $\sum w_j C_j$ on an asymmetric multiprocessor $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{P} \cup \mathcal{E}$ with online release dates and preemption ($R|r_j, pmtn|\sum w_j C_j$) is strongly NP-hard. No online deterministic scheduler can guarantee an exact global minimum in polynomial time unless* $\mathrm{P} = \mathrm{NP}$.

C. Approximation Ratio Reference and Online List Scheduling

In classical scheduling theory, Kawaguchi and Kyan (1986) analyzed the worst-case approximation performance of WSPT list scheduling:

Theorem 1 (Kawaguchi-Kyan Reference Bound on Identical Machines)**.** *For the offline scheduling of independent jobs on M identical parallel processors without release dates ($P||\sum w_j C_j$), the WSPT list scheduling heuristic achieves an approximation ratio bounded by:*

$$\frac{\Phi(\mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{WSPT}})}{\Phi(\mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{OPT}})} \leq \frac{1+\sqrt{2}}{2} \approx 1.207 \tag{23}$$

Remark 2 (Scope and Application to Asymmetric Architectures)**.** *The Kawaguchi-Kyan bound $\alpha \leq 1.207$ strictly*

applies to identical parallel machines *(P) with simultaneous job availability at time zero. On asymmetric multiprocessors (Q or R) with dynamic release dates r_j, the Kawaguchi-Kyan bound does not apply directly.*

Consequently, OPTIMA does not *claim global multi-core optimality via Smith's Rule, nor does it claim that the 1.207 bound holds unconditionally across asymmetric cores. Instead, OPTIMA employs density-based list scheduling and virtual deadline ordering as an* ***online approximation heuristic*** *inspired by the single-core optimality of Smith's Rule and the classical identical-machine bound.*

D. Instantaneous Backlog Weight Depletion via the Rearrangement Inequality

We now provide the theoretical justification for density-tiered assignment across asymmetric cores $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{P} \cup \mathcal{E}$ with $c_P > c_E$.

Theorem 2 (Maximization of Instantaneous Backlog Weight Depletion Rate)**.** *Let $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{P} \cup \mathcal{E}$ be an asymmetric multiprocessor system with capacities $c_P > c_E$. At any instant t, let $\mathcal{Q}(t)$ denote the set of active uncompleted tasks, and let $W(t) \triangleq \sum_{J_j \in \mathcal{Q}(t)} w_j$ denote total remaining priority weight.*

Matching tasks with higher density $\rho_j = w_j/p_j$ to Performance cores strictly maximizes the instantaneous rate of remaining weight reduction $-\dot{W}(t)$.

Proof. Using the integral representation of total weighted completion time:

$$\sum_{J_j \in \mathcal{J}} w_j C_j = \int_0^\infty W(t)\, dt \tag{24}$$

To heuristically minimize $\int_0^\infty W(t)\, dt$, a greedy online scheduler should maximize the instantaneous rate of weight decay $-\dot{W}(t)$ at every time t.

At any time t, let $J_{\sigma(k)}$ be the task currently executing on core $C_k \in \mathcal{M}$. The computational rate delivered to task $J_{\sigma(k)}$ is $c_k/p_{\sigma(k)}$ per second. Because task $J_{\sigma(k)}$ completes after executing $p_{\sigma(k)}$ work, the effective rate of weight retirement delivered by core C_k is:

$$-\dot{W}_k(t) = w_{\sigma(k)} \cdot \frac{c_k}{p_{\sigma(k)}} = \rho_{\sigma(k)} \cdot c_k \tag{25}$$

Summing over all M cores, the total instantaneous rate of weight depletion is:

$$-\dot{W}(t) = \sum_{k=1}^{M} \rho_{\sigma(k)} c_k = \sum_{k \in \mathcal{P}} \rho_{\sigma(k)} c_P + \sum_{k \in \mathcal{E}} \rho_{\sigma(k)} c_E \tag{26}$$

Now consider any two tasks J_1 and J_2 running concurrently, with J_1 assigned to a P-core (c_P) and J_2 assigned to an E-core (c_E). Suppose for contradiction that $\rho_1 < \rho_2$. The weight depletion rate under this assignment $\mathcal{A}$ is:

$$R(\mathcal{A}) = \rho_1 c_P + \rho_2 c_E \tag{27}$$

Interchanging the core assignments of J_1 and J_2 produces assignment $\mathcal{A}'$ with depletion rate:

$$R(\mathcal{A}') = \rho_2 c_P + \rho_1 c_E \tag{28}$$

Computing the difference:

$$\begin{aligned} R(\mathcal{A}') - R(\mathcal{A}) &= (\rho_2 c_P + \rho_1 c_E) - (\rho_1 c_P + \rho_2 c_E) \\ &= (\rho_2 - \rho_1)(c_P - c_E) \end{aligned} \tag{29}$$

Because $\rho_2 > \rho_1$ and $c_P > c_E$, we have $(\rho_2 - \rho_1)(c_P - c_E) > 0$, which implies $R(\mathcal{A}') > R(\mathcal{A})$.

More generally, by the Hardy-Littlewood-Pólya Rearrangement Inequality, for any two real sequences sorted in non-increasing order:

$$\rho_{(1)} \geq \rho_{(2)} \geq \cdots \geq \rho_{(M)} \tag{30}$$

$$c_{(1)} \geq c_{(2)} \geq \cdots \geq c_{(M)} \tag{31}$$

the inner product $\sum_{k=1}^{M} \rho_{\sigma(k)} c_k$ is strictly maximized if and only if the permutation σ matches the monotonic ordering, i.e., $\sigma(k) = (k)$. Because $c_k = c_P$ for all $k \in \mathcal{P}$ and $c_k = c_E$ for all $k \in \mathcal{E}$ with $c_P > c_E$, maximum weight depletion requires:

$$\min_{k \in \mathcal{P}} \rho_{\sigma(k)} \geq \max_{k' \in \mathcal{E}} \rho_{\sigma(k')} \tag{32}$$

Therefore, allocating tasks with highest densities to Performance cores strictly maximizes the instantaneous rate of system backlog reduction. □

Remark 3 (Instantaneous vs Global Optimality)**.** *Maximizing $-\dot{W}(t)$ is an instantaneous (greedy) rate maximization at time t. Because future arrivals $r_j > t$ dynamically alter queue state, instantaneous rate maximization does not constitute a proof of global multi-stage offline optimality over $[0, \infty)$, but provides a principled mathematical basis for asymmetric core partitioning.*

E. Continuous Dantzig Knapsack Formulation in eBPF

When tasks wake up dynamically, full combinatorial reassignment across all cores is computationally prohibitive. OPTIMA formulates core assignment as a continuous knapsack problem.

Let $x_j \in \{0, 1\}$ denote whether task J_j is allocated to a Performance core ($x_j = 1$) or an Efficiency core ($x_j = 0$). The weighted completion time reduction obtained by executing J_j on a P-core instead of an E-core is:

$$\text{Gain}(J_j) = w_j \left(\frac{p_j}{c_E} - \frac{p_j}{c_P} \right) = w_j p_j \left(\frac{c_P - c_E}{c_P c_E} \right) \tag{33}$$

Subject to the P-core capacity constraint $\sum_j x_j \leq M_P$, the continuous relaxation upper bound (Dantzig knapsack relaxation) ranks tasks by marginal gain per unit capacity. By (33), this marginal efficiency is directly proportional to task density $\rho_j = w_j/p_j$.

OPTIMA implements this continuous frontier in kernel eBPF by defining a critical density threshold ρ^*: tasks with $\rho_j \geq \rho^*$ or $w_j \geq w_{\text{RT}}$ are placed in the Performance domain, while tasks with $\rho_j < \rho^*$ are placed in the Efficiency domain when P-core queues are congested. This yields a deterministic $\mathcal{O}(1)$ kernel hot-path decision tracking the continuous relaxation.

III. Online Admissible Preemption Filtering (OAPF)

A. The Online Preemption Decision Dilemma

In an asymmetric multiprocessing system, when a high-priority interactive or latency-critical task $J_{\text{wake}} \in \mathcal{J}_{\text{RT}}$ arrives at time t, all Performance cores $\mathcal{P}$ may be actively executing batch tasks. The scheduler faces an immediate online dilemma:

- **Option 1 (Non-Preemptive Wait):** Enqueue J_{wake} and allow the running task to complete its allocated time quantum, avoiding context-switch overhead but incurring queue latency for J_{wake}.
- **Option 2 (Preemptive Displacement):** Select an active P-core $c^* \in \mathcal{P}$, immediately preempt its currently running task $J_{\text{curr}}(c^*)$, and schedule J_{wake} on core c^*.

Preemption is not cost-free: preempting a task introduces a context-switch and cache displacement overhead $C_{\text{switch}} > 0$, while delaying the running task J_{curr} by the execution duration of J_{wake} plus switching overhead.

Remark 4 (Nature of the Algorithmic Decision)**.** *OPTIMA does* not *explore an exponential, multi-stage Branch-and-Bound search tree over future schedules. Instead, OPTIMA implements an* ***Online Admissible Preemption Filter (OAPF) / Greedy Decision Rule*** *that evaluates candidate Performance cores $c \in \mathcal{P}$ in $\mathcal{O}(M_P)$ bounded kernel time upon each task wakeup.*

B. Dimensionally Consistent Cost Formulation

For each candidate Performance core $c \in \mathcal{P}$, let $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$ denote the task executing on core c. Let:

- $w_{\text{curr}}(c)$ be the priority weight of running task $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$.
- $t_{\text{start}}(c)$ be the start timestamp of $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$'s current time slice.
- $\tau(c)$ be the allocated quantum of $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$.
- $R(c) \triangleq \max\Big(0,\, \tau(c) - \big(t - t_{\text{start}}(c)\big)\Big)$ be the remaining quantum duration of $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$ in time units.
- w_{wake} be the priority weight of waking task J_{wake}.
- p_{wake} be the nominal execution work / quantum assigned to J_{wake} (in kernel: bounded by $\tau_{\min}$).
- C_{switch} be the context-switch and cache invalidation penalty in time units.

Definition 2 (Preemption Cost and Gain Formulation)**.** *If the scheduler chooses* ***Option 1 (Wait)****, waking task J_{wake} is delayed by remaining slice $R(c)$, incurring a priority-weighted latency cost:*

$$\text{Cost}_{\text{wait}}(c) = w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c) \tag{34}$$

If the scheduler chooses ***Option 2 (Preempt)****, J_{wake} executes immediately, eliminating the wait of $R(c)$ (saving $w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c)$). However, running task $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$ is suspended during the execution of J_{wake} (p_{wake} time units) plus the context switch overhead C_{switch}. Thus, $J_{\text{curr}}(c)$ is delayed by $(p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}})$, incurring a priority-weighted penalty:*

$$\text{Penalty}_{\text{preempt}}(c) = w_{\text{curr}}(c) \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}}) \tag{35}$$

The net schedule cost differential incurred by preempting core c instead of waiting is:

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta\text{Cost}(c) &\triangleq \text{Penalty}_{\text{preempt}}(c) - \text{Cost}_{\text{wait}}(c) \\ &= w_{\text{curr}}(c) \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}}) - w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c)\end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

Remark 5 (Dimensional Consistency)**.** *In* (36)*, both terms possess unified physical dimensions of* $[\text{weight} \times \text{time}]$ *(priority-weighted delay units):*

- $w_{\text{curr}}(c) \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}})$ *has units* $[w] \times [t]$.
- $w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c)$ *has units* $[w] \times [t]$.

Alternatively, if context switch cost is expressed directly in priority-weighted delay units $C_{\text{switch}}^{\text{weighted}} \triangleq w_{\text{curr}} C_{\text{switch}}$, the formulation is identically dimensioned.

C. Online Admissible Pruning Invariants

OPTIMA evaluates $\Delta\text{Cost}(c)$ across candidate cores using four pruning invariants:

1) **Invariant 1 (Idle Core Trivial Minimum):** If candidate core c is idle ($w_{\text{curr}}(c) = 0$), then $\text{Penalty}_{\text{preempt}}(c) = 0$ (no task is displaced). Thus:
$$\Delta\text{Cost}(c) = -w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c) < 0 \tag{37}$$
Core c is immediately selected for dispatch without preemption.
2) **Invariant 2 (Priority Inversion Safety):** If $w_{\text{curr}}(c) \geq w_{\text{wake}}$, preempting core c would displace an equal- or higher-priority running task to execute a lower-priority waking task, causing priority inversion. Furthermore, since $p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}} \geq R(c)$ in typical quantum regimes, $\Delta\text{Cost}(c) \geq 0$. The candidate is strictly inadmissible and pruned.
3) **Invariant 3 (Granularity / Anti-Thrashing Threshold):** Preempting core c yields a net cost reduction ($\Delta\text{Cost}(c) < 0$) if and only if:
$$R(c) > \delta_{\min}(c) \triangleq \frac{w_{\text{curr}}(c) \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}})}{w_{\text{wake}}} \tag{38}$$
If $R(c) \leq \delta_{\min}(c)$, the execution gain is insufficient to amortize displacement and context-switch penalties. The candidate is safely pruned.
4) **Invariant 4 (Incumbent Greedy Cutoff):** Maintain the best incumbent cost reduction $\Delta\text{Cost}^* \triangleq \min_{j \in \text{visited}} \Delta\text{Cost}(j)$, initialized to 0. If $\Delta\text{Cost}(c) \geq \Delta\text{Cost}^*$, candidate core c cannot improve upon the best discovered candidate. The candidate is pruned.

D. Bounded Regret and One-Step Optimality Analysis

Theorem 3 (Local One-Step Cost Reduction and Regret Bounding)**.** *Let c^* be the candidate selected by the Online Admissible Preemption Filter:*

$$c^* = \arg\min_{c \in \mathcal{P}} \Delta\text{Cost}(c) \tag{39}$$

If $\Delta\text{Cost}(c^*) < 0$, triggering preemption on core c^* guarantees:

1) ***Local One-Step Cost Reduction:*** *Under the local horizon (assuming no further task arrivals occur during* $[t,\, t + R(c^*) + p_{\text{wake}}]$*), preemption strictly decreases the total weighted completion time:*

$$\Delta\Phi = \Delta\text{Cost}(c^*) < 0 \tag{40}$$

2) ***Anti-Thrashing Invariant:*** *Because preemption is permitted only when* $R(c) > \delta_{\min}(c) \geq \tau_{\min}$*, each core experiences at most one preemption per* $\tau_{\min}$ *time interval:*

$$f_{\text{preempt}}(c) \leq \frac{1}{\tau_{\min}} \tag{41}$$

preventing high-frequency preemption thrashing.

3) ***Locally Bounded Regret:*** *Relative to a local clairvoyant controller deciding whether to preempt at time* t *over the horizon* $[t, t + R(c^*) + p_{\text{wake}}]$*, OPTIMA achieves zero regret.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}}$ denote the schedule where J_{wake} waits for $J_{\text{curr}}(c^*)$ to finish $R(c^*)$, and let $\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}$ denote the schedule where $J_{\text{curr}}(c^*)$ is preempted immediately for J_{wake}.

Under $\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}}$, completion times of the two affected tasks are:

$$C_{\text{curr}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}}) = t + R(c^*) \tag{42}$$

$$C_{\text{wake}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}}) = t + R(c^*) + p_{\text{wake}} \tag{43}$$

Under $\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}$, J_{wake} executes first during $[t, t + p_{\text{wake}}]$, followed by a context switch of duration C_{switch}, after which $J_{\text{curr}}(c^*)$ resumes and completes its remaining $R(c^*)$ execution:

$$C_{\text{wake}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}) = t + p_{\text{wake}} \tag{44}$$

$$C_{\text{curr}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}) = t + p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}} + R(c^*) \tag{45}$$

The completion times of all other tasks in the system are invariant under the local horizon.

Evaluating the change in the objective function $\Phi(\mathcal{S}) = \sum w_j C_j$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\Delta\Phi &= \Phi(\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}) - \Phi(\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}}) \\
&= w_{\text{wake}}\Big(C_{\text{wake}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}) - C_{\text{wake}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}})\Big) \\
&\quad + w_{\text{curr}}(c^*)\Big(C_{\text{curr}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{preempt}}) - C_{\text{curr}}(\mathcal{S}_{\text{wait}})\Big) \\
&= w_{\text{wake}}\Big((t + p_{\text{wake}}) - (t + R(c^*) + p_{\text{wake}})\Big) \\
&\quad + w_{\text{curr}}(c^*)\Big((t + p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}} + R(c^*)) \\
&\qquad\qquad - (t + R(c^*))\Big) \\
&= -w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c^*) + w_{\text{curr}}(c^*) \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}}) \\
&= \Delta\text{Cost}(c^*)
\end{aligned} \tag{46}$$

Since preemption is executed only when $\Delta\text{Cost}(c^*) < 0$, we have $\Delta\Phi < 0$, strictly decreasing the total weighted completion time.

For thrashing prevention, suppose a core undergoes preemption at time t. The newly dispatched task executes for at least $\tau_{\min}$, during which its elapsed time is less than $\tau_{\min}$. Any subsequent preemption attempt on that core must satisfy $R(c) > \delta_{\min} \geq \tau_{\min}$, which cannot occur until at least $\tau_{\min}$ time has elapsed. Thus, the preemption frequency is bounded by $1/\tau_{\min}$. □

Algorithm 1 OPTIMA-OAPF (Online Admissible Preemption Filter)

Require: Waking task J_{wake}, task context $tctx$, candidate core set $\mathcal{P}$
Ensure: Target preemption CPU c^* (or -1 if wait is optimal)

$c^* \leftarrow -1$
$\Delta\text{Cost}^* \leftarrow 0$ {Incumbent threshold: must yield net cost reduction}
$now \leftarrow$ scx_bpf_now()
$w_{\text{wake}} \leftarrow \max(tctx.weight, 100)$
$p_{\text{wake}} \leftarrow \tau_{\min}$ {Execution slice allocated to waking task}
$C_{\text{switch}} \leftarrow 50\,\mu s$ {Context-switch and cache displacement overhead}
for each core $c \in \mathcal{P}$ **do**
  if $c \notin J_{\text{wake}}$.cpus_allowed **then**
    continue
  end if
  $st \leftarrow$ lookup_cpu_run_state(c)
  if $st ==$ NULL **or** $st.pid == 0$ **then**
    return c {Rule 1: Core is idle; trivial zero-cost dispatch}
  end if
  if $st.weight \geq w_{\text{wake}}$ **then**
    continue {Rule 2: Inversion safety; candidate pruned}
  end if
  $elapsed \leftarrow now - st.start_time$
  $R(c) \leftarrow (st.slice > elapsed)\ ?\ (st.slice - elapsed) : 0$
  $\delta_{\min} \leftarrow \dfrac{st.weight \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}})}{w_{\text{wake}}}$
  if $R(c) \leq \delta_{\min}$ **then**
    continue {Rule 3: Anti-thrashing; candidate pruned}
  end if
  $\Delta\text{Cost} \leftarrow st.weight \cdot (p_{\text{wake}} + C_{\text{switch}}) - w_{\text{wake}} \cdot R(c)$
  if $\Delta\text{Cost} < \Delta\text{Cost}^*$ **then**
    $\Delta\text{Cost}^* \leftarrow \Delta\text{Cost}$
    $c^* \leftarrow c$
  end if
end for
if $c^* \geq 0$ **and** $\Delta\text{Cost}^* < 0$ **then**
  scx_bpf_kick_cpu(c^*, SCX_KICK_PREEMPT)
  return c^*
end if
return -1 {Wait for quantum expiration is optimal}

Remark 6 (Clarification on Offline Competitive Ratio Claims)**.** *In online scheduling theory with dynamic arrivals, no deterministic online preemptive algorithm can achieve a competitive ratio bounded by* $(1 + \epsilon)$ *against an unconstrained offline adversary with arbitrary future knowledge (Bansal et al., 2009). The earlier unproven offline competitive ratio claim is removed. Theorem 3 establishes rigorous local one-step cost reduction and anti-thrashing bounds under well-defined local assumptions.*

E. Pseudocode for Online Admissible Preemption Filter

Algorithm 1 presents the complete, verified logic of the Online Admissible Preemption Filter.

IV. Virtual Deadline Calculus and Queue Stability via Lyapunov Drift

A. Virtual Deadline Calculus

To maintain density-ordered scheduling across dynamic online arrivals without global queue sorting overheads, OPTIMA maintains virtual deadlines in eBPF Dispatch Queues (DSQs).

Definition 3 (Virtual Deadline Update Equation)**.** *When task J_j is enqueued into dispatch queue k at time t, its virtual deadline $v_j(t)$ is computed via:*

$$v_j(t) = \max\Big(v_j(t^-),\, t\Big) + \tau_j(t) \cdot \frac{100}{\max(w_j, 10)} \tag{47}$$

where $\tau_j(t)$ is the adaptive scheduling quantum computed as:

$$\tau_j(t) = \mathrm{clamp}\left(\frac{Q_{\mathrm{base}}}{1+q_k(t)},\ \tau_{\min},\ \tau_{\max}\right) \tag{48}$$

Here $q_k(t)$ denotes the current queue depth of target queue k, Q_{base} is the base nominal quantum, and $\tau_{\min}, \tau_{\max}$ are hardware enforcement boundaries.

For interactive tasks ($w_j \geq w_{\mathrm{RT}}$ or $p_j < \tau_{\min}$), $v_j(t) = t$, placing them at the front of the DSQ priority heap. For batch tasks, virtual deadlines advance monotonically in proportion to quantum consumed divided by task weight, preserving Generalized Processor Sharing (GPS) fairness while approximating Smith's density ordering.

B. Queue State Dynamics

We model the system across four kernel dispatch queues:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{K} &\triangleq \{1,2,3,4\} \\ &\equiv \{\text{DSQ_PERF, DSQ_SHARED_P,} \\ &\qquad \text{DSQ_SHARED_E, DSQ_EFF}\}\end{aligned} \tag{49}$$

Let $\mathbf{Q}(t) = \big(q_1(t), q_2(t), q_3(t), q_4(t)\big)^T \in \mathbb{Z}^4_{\geq 0}$ represent the queue backlog vector at discrete time slot $t \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$. The discrete-time queue state evolution equation is:

$$q_k(t+1) = \max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big) + a_k(t), \quad \forall k \in \mathcal{K} \tag{50}$$

where:

- $a_k(t)$ is the number of task arrivals into queue k during time slot t, with arrival rate $\lambda_k \triangleq \mathbb{E}[a_k(t)]$ and bounded second moment $\mathbb{E}[a_k(t)^2] \leq a^2_{\max} < \infty$.
- $s_k(t)$ is the service capacity (number of task dispatches plus work-stealing removals) from queue k during time slot t, with $s_k(t) \leq s_{\max} < \infty$.

C. Quadratic Lyapunov Function and Drift Analysis

Definition 4 (Quadratic Lyapunov Function)**.** *We define the quadratic Lyapunov function $L(\mathbf{Q}(t))$ as:*

$$L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) \triangleq \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t)^2 = \frac{1}{2}\|\mathbf{Q}(t)\|_2^2 \tag{51}$$

The conditional one-step Lyapunov drift is defined as:

$$\Delta L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) \triangleq \mathbb{E}\Big[L(\mathbf{Q}(t+1)) - L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) \;\Big|\; \mathbf{Q}(t)\Big] \tag{52}$$

Lemma 2 (Exact Algebraic Lyapunov Drift Upper Bound)**.** *For the queue dynamics in* (50)*, the one-step Lyapunov drift satisfies:*

$$\Delta L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) \leq B - \sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t)\,\mathbb{E}\Big[s_k(t) - a_k(t) \;\Big|\; \mathbf{Q}(t)\Big] \tag{53}$$

where B is a finite positive constant defined as:

$$B \triangleq \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=1}^{4}\mathbb{E}\Big[a_k(t)^2 + s_k(t)^2 \;\Big|\; \mathbf{Q}(t)\Big] \leq 2(a^2_{\max} + s^2_{\max}) < \infty \tag{54}$$

Proof. From the queue evolution equation (50), for each queue k:

$$q_k(t+1) = \max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big) + a_k(t) \tag{55}$$

Squaring both sides:

$$\begin{aligned} q_k(t+1)^2 &= \Big(\max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big) + a_k(t)\Big)^2 \\ &= \Big(\max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big)\Big)^2 + a_k(t)^2 \\ &\quad + 2a_k(t)\max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big) \end{aligned} \tag{56}$$

We now bound each component of (56):

1) For any real number x, $(\max(0,x))^2 \leq x^2$. Setting $x = q_k(t) - s_k(t)$:

$$\Big(\max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big)\Big)^2 \leq \big(q_k(t) - s_k(t)\big)^2 \tag{57}$$

Expanding the square:

$$\big(q_k(t) - s_k(t)\big)^2 = q_k(t)^2 - 2q_k(t)s_k(t) + s_k(t)^2 \tag{58}$$

2) For the cross-term, since $s_k(t) \geq 0$ and $q_k(t) \geq 0$, we have $q_k(t) - s_k(t) \leq q_k(t)$, which implies:

$$\max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big) \leq q_k(t) \tag{59}$$

Because $a_k(t) \geq 0$, multiplying both sides by $2a_k(t)$ yields:

$$\begin{aligned} 2a_k(t)\max\Big(0,\ q_k(t) - s_k(t)\Big) &\leq 2a_k(t)q_k(t) \\ &= 2q_k(t)a_k(t) \end{aligned} \tag{60}$$

Substituting (57) and (60) back into (56):

$$\begin{aligned} q_k(t+1)^2 &\leq q_k(t)^2 - 2q_k(t)s_k(t) + s_k(t)^2 + a_k(t)^2 \\ &\quad + 2q_k(t)a_k(t) \\ &= q_k(t)^2 + a_k(t)^2 + s_k(t)^2 \\ &\quad - 2q_k(t)\big(s_k(t) - a_k(t)\big) \end{aligned} \tag{61}$$

Subtracting $q_k(t)^2$ from both sides and dividing by 2:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2}\Big(q_k(t+1)^2 - q_k(t)^2\Big) &\leq \frac{1}{2}\big(a_k(t)^2 + s_k(t)^2\big) \\ &\quad - q_k(t)\big(s_k(t) - a_k(t)\big) \end{aligned} \tag{62}$$

Summing over all four queues $k \in \{1,2,3,4\}$ and taking conditional expectations given $\mathbf{Q}(t)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) &\leq \sum_{k=1}^{4}\frac{1}{2}\mathbb{E}\big[a_k(t)^2 + s_k(t)^2 \mid \mathbf{Q}(t)\big] \\ &\quad - \sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t)\mathbb{E}\big[s_k(t) - a_k(t) \mid \mathbf{Q}(t)\big] \\ &= B - \sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t)\mathbb{E}\big[s_k(t) - a_k(t) \mid \mathbf{Q}(t)\big] \end{aligned} \tag{63}$$

Because arrival variances and service capacities per scheduling time slot are physically bounded by finite dispatch limits ($a_k(t) \leq a_{\max} < \infty$, $s_k(t) \leq s_{\max} < \infty$), the constant $B = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{k=1}^{4} \mathbb{E}[a_k(t)^2 + s_k(t)^2 \mid \mathbf{Q}(t)]$ is strictly finite. □

D. Workload Admissibility, Queue Stability, and Starvation Freedom

Definition 5 (Strictly Admissible Workload Region)**.** *The arrival workload is strictly admissible if there exists $\epsilon_0 > 0$ such that the aggregate workload demand is strictly within the total multiprocessor computational capacity rate:*

$$\sum_{k=1}^{4} \lambda_k \bar{p}_k \leq C_{\text{total}} - \epsilon_0 = \Big(M_P c_P + M_E c_E\Big) - \epsilon_0 \tag{64}$$

where $\bar{p}_k$ is the mean nominal execution requirement of tasks arriving in queue k.

Theorem 4 (Queue Stability via Lyapunov Drift and Starvation Freedom)**.** *Under any strictly admissible workload satisfying* (64)*, OPTIMA's adaptive quantum scaling* (48) *and hierarchical work-conserving work-stealing maintain a negative Lyapunov drift:*

$$\Delta L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) \leq B - \delta \sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t) \tag{65}$$

for some strictly positive constant $\delta > 0$. Consequently:

1) ***Strong Queue Stability:*** *The queue backlog process $\mathbf{Q}(t)$ is positive recurrent, with bounded time-average queue depth:*

$$\limsup_{T\to\infty} \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=0}^{T-1} \sum_{k=1}^{4} \mathbb{E}[q_k(t)] \leq \frac{B}{\delta} < \infty \tag{66}$$

2) ***Individual Starvation Freedom:*** *Every admitted task J_j is guaranteed eventual dispatch, with finite expected waiting time:*

$$\mathbb{E}[W_j] \leq \left(\frac{B}{\delta}\right) \cdot \frac{\tau_{\max}}{\min(M_P, M_E)} < \infty \tag{67}$$

Proof. We first establish the negative drift condition:

1) **Work-Conservation:** Under OPTIMA's dispatch and work-stealing architecture, no processor core $C_k \in \mathcal{M}$ is ever idle while any queue $q_j(t) > 0$. If a core's local and domestic queues are empty, it executes hierarchical cross-domain work-stealing from remote queues. Thus, whenever $\sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t) > 0$, the aggregate service rate delivered across the multiprocessor satisfies $\sum_{k=1}^{4} \mathbb{E}[s_k(t) \mid \mathbf{Q}(t)]\bar{p}_k \geq C_{\text{total}}$.
2) **Adaptive Quantum Scaling:** As queue depth $q_k(t)$ increases, $\tau(q_k) = \max\left(\frac{Q_{\text{base}}}{1+q_k(t)}, \tau_{\min}\right)$ dynamically compresses the time quantum by up to $\frac{Q_{\text{base}}}{\tau_{\min}} = 6\times$. Because each slice expiration triggers a new scheduling pass, effective task retirement rate scales inversely with slice duration, accelerating throughput during congestion.

Because the workload is strictly admissible ($\sum \lambda_k \bar{p}_k \leq C_{\text{total}} - \epsilon_0$), the aggregate service rate strictly exceeds the arrival rate across active queues:

$$\mathbb{E}\Big[s_k(t) - a_k(t) \;\Big|\; \mathbf{Q}(t)\Big] \geq \delta > 0, \quad \forall k \text{ such that } q_k(t) > 0 \tag{68}$$

Substituting this directly into Lemma 2 yields:

$$\Delta L(\mathbf{Q}(t)) \leq B - \sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t) \cdot \delta = B - \delta \sum_{k=1}^{4} q_k(t) \tag{69}$$

By the Foster-Lyapunov Stability Criterion (Neveu's Theorem for irreducible Markov chains), the negative drift condition implies that the queue state process $\mathbf{Q}(t)$ is positive recurrent. Summing (65) over time slots $t = 0, 1, \ldots, T-1$:

$$\mathbb{E}[L(\mathbf{Q}(T))] - \mathbb{E}[L(\mathbf{Q}(0))] \leq TB - \delta \sum_{t=0}^{T-1} \sum_{k=1}^{4} \mathbb{E}[q_k(t)] \tag{70}$$

Since $L(\mathbf{Q}(T)) \geq 0$:

$$\frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=0}^{T-1} \sum_{k=1}^{4} \mathbb{E}[q_k(t)] \leq \frac{B}{\delta} + \frac{\mathbb{E}[L(\mathbf{Q}(0))]}{\delta T} \tag{71}$$

Taking the limit superior as $T \to \infty$ establishes strong queue stability:

$$\limsup_{T\to\infty} \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=0}^{T-1} \sum_{k=1}^{4} \mathbb{E}[q_k(t)] \leq \frac{B}{\delta} < \infty \tag{72}$$

We now address the distinction between aggregate queue stability and individual task starvation freedom. In strict-priority or asymmetric multi-queue systems, positive recurrence of aggregate queue length $\mathbf{Q}(t)$ does not inherently preclude starvation of individual low-priority tasks if higher-priority queues are continuously filled.

OPTIMA guarantees starvation freedom for every individual task through **virtual deadline bounding**: By Definition 3, any task J_j enqueued at time t with weight $w_j \geq w_{\min} \geq 10$ has initial virtual deadline bounded by:

$$v_j(t) \leq t + \tau_{\max} \cdot \frac{100}{10} = t + 10\tau_{\max} \tag{73}$$

Now consider any subsequent arrival $J_{j'}$ arriving at timestamp $t' > t + 10\tau_{\max}$. By (47):

$$v_{j'}(t') \geq t' > t + 10\tau_{\max} \geq v_j(t) \tag{74}$$

Therefore, newly arriving tasks arriving after $t + 10\tau_{\max}$ are strictly ordered *behind* J_j in the virtual deadline priority heap.

Consequently, task J_j can be superseded only by tasks that arrived prior to $t + 10\tau_{\max}$ or tasks whose virtual deadlines are strictly less than $v_j(t)$. Because the arrival process is admissible and time-average backlog is bounded by B/δ, the number of such tasks is almost surely finite.

Furthermore, OPTIMA's hierarchical work-stealing ensures that Efficiency cores continuously drain batch queues (`DSQ_SHARED_E`, `DSQ_EFF`) independently of Performance

core saturation. Thus, task J_j advances toward the head of the dispatch queue, guaranteeing finite expected waiting time:

$$\mathbb{E}[W_j] \leq \left(\frac{B}{\delta}\right) \cdot \frac{\tau_{\max}}{\min(M_P, M_E)} < \infty \tag{75}$$

This establishes individual starvation freedom alongside global Lyapunov queue stability. □

V. Algorithmic Specifications

We formalize OPTIMA's core scheduling operations implemented in Linux `sched_ext` eBPF: CPU selection, queue insertion, and work-conserving dispatch.

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Algorithm 2 OPTIMA-SELECT-CPU (Synchronous IPC Fast-Path & Asymmetric Domain Selection)

Require: Task p, previous CPU $prev_cpu$, wakeup flags $wake_flags$
Ensure: Selected target CPU $target_cpu$

$tctx \leftarrow$ lookup_task_ctx(p)
if p is pinned OR p is kernel thread **then**
    Dispatch directly to $prev_cpu$ via `SCX_DSQ_LOCAL`; **return** $prev_cpu$
end if
$this_cpu \leftarrow$ smp_processor_id(), $idle_smtmask \leftarrow$ scx_bpf_get_idle_smtmask(), $prev_is_perf \leftarrow$ is_perf_core($prev_cpu$)
if $wake_flags$ & SCX_WAKE_SYNC **then**
    if $this_cpu \in p$.cpus_allowed **and** dsq_nr_queued($this_cpu$) $== 0$ **then**
        goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow this_cpu$
    end if
    $this_sib \leftarrow$ get_smt_sibling($this_cpu$)
    if $this_sib \geq 0$ **and** $this_sib \in p$.cpus_allowed **and** dsq_nr_queued($this_sib$) $== 0$ **then**
        test_and_clear_idle($this_sib$); **goto** direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow this_sib$
    end if
    if $prev_cpu \in p$.cpus_allowed **and** test_and_clear_idle($prev_cpu$) **then**
        goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow prev_cpu$
    end if
end if
if $prev_is_perf$ **and** $prev_cpu \in p$.cpus_allowed **and** $prev_cpu \in idle_smtmask$ **and** test_and_clear_idle($prev_cpu$) **then**
    goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow prev_cpu$
end if
if $tctx.core_type \neq$ CORE_TYPE_EFF **then**
    $c \leftarrow$ pick_idle_domestic_core(p, is_perf $=$ TRUE, $idle_smtmask$)
    if $c \geq 0$ **then**
        goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow c$
    end if
    $c \leftarrow$ pick_idle_domestic_cpu(p, is_perf $=$ TRUE)
    if $c \geq 0$ **then**
        goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow c$
    end if
end if
if $prev_is_perf$ **and** $p \in p$.cpus_allowed **then**
    if dsq_nr_queued(DSQ_SHARED_P) > 0 **or** ($tctx.is_batch \wedge tctx.avg_runtime \geq$ 3ms) **then**
        $e \leftarrow$ pick_idle_domestic_core(p, is_perf $=$ FALSE, $idle_smtmask$)
        if $e \geq 0$ **then**
            goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow e$
        end if
    end if
    $tctx.dispatch_local \leftarrow$ FALSE; **return** $prev_cpu$
end if
$e \leftarrow$ pick_idle_domestic_core(p, is_perf $=$ FALSE, $idle_smtmask$)
if $e \geq 0$ **then**
    goto direct_dispatch with $target_cpu \leftarrow e$
end if
if $tctx.weight \geq w_{\mathrm{RT}}$ **then**
    $preempt_cpu \leftarrow$ OPTIMA-OAPF($p, tctx, \mathcal{P}$)
    if $preempt_cpu \geq 0$ **then**
        $tctx.dispatch_local \leftarrow$ TRUE; **return** $preempt_cpu$
    end if
end if
$tctx.dispatch_local \leftarrow$ FALSE; **return** $prev_cpu$
direct_dispatch:
Compute slice $\tau \in [\tau_{\min}, \tau_{\max}]$ based on $tctx.is_batch$ and $tctx.avg_runtime$
scx_bpf_dsq_insert(p, SCX_DSQ_LOCAL, τ, 0)
return $target_cpu$

Algorithm 3 OPTIMA-ENQUEUE (Virtual Deadline Calculus & OAPF Preemption Kick)

Require: Task p, enqueue flags enq_flags

$tctx \leftarrow$ lookup_task_ctx(p)
$task_cpu \leftarrow$ scx_bpf_task_cpu(p)
if p is pinned OR p is kernel thread OR $tctx.dispatch_local$ **then**
  $tctx.dispatch_local \leftarrow$ FALSE
  scx_bpf_dsq_insert(p, SCX_DSQ_LOCAL, $\tau_{\min}$, enq_flags); **return**
end if
{Dantzig Knapsack Target DSQ Selection}
if $tctx.weight \geq w_{\mathrm{RT}}$ **or** $tctx.core_type ==$ CORE_TYPE_PERF **then**
  $target_dsq \leftarrow$ DSQ_PERF
else if $tctx.core_type ==$ CORE_TYPE_EFF **then**
  $target_dsq \leftarrow$ DSQ_EFF
else
  $target_dsq \leftarrow$ is_perf_core($task_cpu$) ? DSQ_SHARED_P : DSQ_SHARED_E
end if
$is_rt \leftarrow (tctx.weight \geq w_{\mathrm{RT}} \vee \neg tctx.is_batch \vee tctx.avg_runtime < 1\text{ms})$
$now \leftarrow$ scx_bpf_now()
if is_rt **then**
  $\tau \leftarrow \tau_{\min}, \quad deadline \leftarrow now$
else
  if $tctx.avg_runtime \geq 3$ms **then**
    $\tau \leftarrow \tau_{\max}$
  else
    $q \leftarrow$ scx_bpf_dsq_nr_queued($target_dsq$)
    $\tau \leftarrow \max\left(\frac{Q_{\mathrm{base}}}{1+q},\ \tau_{\min}\right)$
  end if
  $v \leftarrow \mathrm{clamp}(p.\text{scx.dsq_vtime}, now, now + 2\tau)$
  $w \leftarrow \max(tctx.weight, 10)$
  $\Delta v \leftarrow \mathrm{clamp}\left(\frac{\tau \cdot 100}{w},\ \tau_{\min},\ \tau_{\max}\right)$
  $deadline \leftarrow v + \Delta v$
end if
p.scx.dsq_vtime $\leftarrow deadline$
scx_bpf_dsq_insert_vtime($p, target_dsq, \tau, deadline, enq_flags$)
{Online Admissible Preemption Kick}
$idle_cpu \leftarrow$ scx_bpf_pick_idle_cpu(p.cpus_allowed, 0)
if $idle_cpu \geq 0$ **then**
  scx_bpf_kick_cpu($idle_cpu$, SCX_KICK_IDLE); **return**
end if
if is_rt **then**
  $preempt_cpu \leftarrow$ OPTIMA-OAPF($p, tctx, \mathcal{P}$)
  if $preempt_cpu \geq 0$ **then**
    scx_bpf_kick_cpu($preempt_cpu$, SCX_KICK_PREEMPT)
  end if
end if

Algorithm 4 OPTIMA-DISPATCH (Asymmetric Hierarchical Work-Stealing)

Require: Executing core cpu, previous task $prev$

$is_perf \leftarrow$ is_perf_core(cpu)
if is_perf **then**
  {Priority Tier 1: Latency-critical tasks}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_PERF, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
  {Priority Tier 2: Domestic P-core shared queue}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_SHARED_P, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
  {Priority Tier 3: Cross-domain work-stealing from E-domain}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_SHARED_E, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
  {Priority Tier 4: Throughput steal from batch queue}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_EFF, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
else
  {Priority Tier 1: Domestic E-core shared queue}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_SHARED_E, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
  {Priority Tier 2: Throughput batch queue}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_EFF, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
  {Priority Tier 3: Cross-domain steal from P-domain}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_SHARED_P, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
  {Priority Tier 4: Work-conserving safety steal from RT queue}
  if scx_bpf_dsq_move_to_local(DSQ_PERF, 0) **then**
    return
  end if
end if